Lars Klander

SPEAKER · AI GOVERNANCE AND CONTROL DESIGN

Thirty years building software for environments where the rules are not optional. Gaming, banking, defence.

HEADSHOT PORTRAIT DROP IN BEFORE SENDING

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I build and operate AI agents inside a regulated business, and I have lived with the consequences when the controls around them do not hold. **Both of my talks are first-hand postmortems of my own production environment**, told against myself, with the numbers left in.

TALKS AVAILABLE NOW

01 The Control Was on the Register. It Was Not in the System.

40 MIN INCL. Q&A | ALSO 30 / 20 | SECURITY LEADERSHIP, RISK, AUDIT, BOARDS | STRATEGIC

We spent six weeks building the controls that govern our AI coding agents. Deny rules, approval structures, the things you would put on a control register and describe to a board. Then we found that design decisions in the infrastructure underneath allowed all of them to be bypassed.

Nobody attacked us. No breach, no incident call, nothing to restore. The controls stopped being controls quietly, because of a dependency we did not own, and every report saying they were in place stayed technically accurate the whole time. A supply chain story wearing an AI costume. It ends where a regulator would start: what evidence of effective operation actually looks like.

02 Deny Rules Are Not Controls: Six Weeks of Agent Guardrails and the Bypass Underneath Them

30 MIN | ~24 MIN IF PRE-RECORDED | PLATFORM AND SECURITY ENGINEERS, AGENT BUILDERS | INTERMEDIATE

The engineering cut of the same six weeks, plus a quieter failure that was in some ways worse: one accidental line in an onboarding configuration silently skewed every piece of code our agents produced for over a week. Nothing alerted. Nothing failed. The system behaved exactly as designed, against an instruction I did not know was there — and no request log in our stack would ever have shown it, because the requests were all fine. Both failures share a shape, and it is the shape most agent deployments are currently in.

WHAT A ROOM LEAVES WITH

- **A one-page test.** Four questions to ask before accepting that an item on an AI control register is actually a control, run live against three real systems.
- **An evidence standard.** What proof of effective operation looks like, from twenty years of producing exactly that under a financial-crime regulator.
- **A gap in third-party review.** Why a control you built and tested can be quietly invalidated by a dependency you never assessed.
- **The decisions to make first.** Detect, triage, escalate, convene, decide no longer fits inside the window. A policy is a sign. A log is a camera. Only an execution rule is a governor.

STANDING

25+
Languages his programming books are translated into, plus a network and cyber security book that ran to two editions

150+
Venues across the US, Australia and Macau running software he helped create; infrastructure delivered to four of the five largest gaming companies in the world

~100
Pieces published since June 2026 on AI governance and control design, read by CISOs, regulators and decision-makers

For organisers

LARS KLANDER · READY-TO-PASTE BIOS AND PRACTICALITIES

BIOS COPY THE ONE THAT FITS THE FIELD

MICRO — PROGRAM BOOKS, SESSION CARDS, PANEL INTROS 45 words

Lars Klander is CTO of Player Elite in Sydney, building AI-driven systems for gaming operators across Australia and the United States. He has spent thirty years in gaming, banking and defense software, and wrote a network and cyber security book that ran to two editions.

SHORT — TIGHT FORM FIELDS, SHOW NOTES, MEETUP LISTINGS 70 words

Lars Klander has spent thirty years building software for gaming, banking and defense — environments where the rules are not optional. He has delivered gaming management infrastructure to four of the five largest gaming companies in the world, and wrote a network and cyber security book that ran to two editions. He is CTO of Player Elite in Sydney, where he builds and operates AI agents inside a regulated business.

MEDIUM — CONFERENCE SPEAKER PROFILES 125 words · as submitted to Conf42

Lars Klander has spent thirty years building software for environments where the rules are not optional: gaming, banking and defense. As an independent software vendor he delivered gaming management infrastructure to four of the five largest gaming companies in the world, and software he helped create runs in more than 150 gaming venues across the United States, Australia and Macau. He has written numerous programming books, translated into more than 25 languages, and a network and cyber security book that went through two editions.

For the last decade he has been CTO of Player Elite in Sydney, where he builds and operates AI agents inside a regulated business, and writes daily on AI governance and control design.

A 270-word long-form bio exists in both first and third person, on request. Australian spelling as set; swap to *-ize* forms for US and global venues.

2026 SCHEDULE

DATE	EVENT	STATUS	TALK
23 Sep 2026	**Conf42 AI Agents** Online, pre-recorded	DRAFTED	Deny Rules Are Not Controls
18 Nov 2026	**PerthSEC 2026** Westin Perth, in person	SUBMITTED 4 SEP	The Control Was on the Register

PRACTICALITIES

BASED

Sydney, Australia. Travels from Sydney; regularly in the United States (Las Vegas).

FORMATS

Session, panel, fireside, pre-recorded. Comfortable at 20, 30 and 40 minutes; the 40 is the one with room for the live exercise.

RECORDING

Yes, by default. Two asks: that the final master is shared, and that re-posting rights to his own channel are stated in writing before recording.

VENDOR NEUTRALITY

No product content, ever. His company appears in the bio as context and nowhere in the talk. No named competitors, no logos.

EXCLUSIVITY

Several venues require previously unpresented material. He tracks where every incident and framework has been spent, so say early if your event needs first-run content.

AV

Slides plus a laptop. Nothing unusual. Will work inside a mandatory template.

LEAD TIME

Prefers to deliver ahead of deadline. Will send a run of show on request.

FURTHER MATERIAL

Additional talks exist in draft on inference sovereignty, agent identity, and the anti-money-laundering desk as a working model for governing machines. They are held back for venues that require first-run content — AusCERT, Regulating the Game and AISA CyberCon are all on the 2027 list — so titles and abstracts go out on request rather than on this sheet. Ask.

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